

Water STRIP

شريط شراكات الابتكار المائي



**Invitation to join the
Water STRIP**

(Participation Invitation Letter)

Distinguished [Title] / [Name],

May God's peace and blessings be upon you.

In alignment with the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia's Vision 2030 and as part of the Ministry of Environment, Water, and Agriculture's (MEWA) commitment to fostering transformative advancements in water technology and sustainability, we are pleased to introduce the Water STRIP, an initiative set to reshape the Kingdom's water sector.

The Water STRIP will serve as a global hub for innovation, bringing together research institutions, businesses, and government entities to drive advancements in desalination, water recycling, and climate-resilient technologies.

The success of Water STRIP depends on the collaboration of key stakeholders across public and private sectors, research institutions, and industry leaders. This initiative will consolidate existing efforts into a unified and official framework, positioning Saudi Arabia as a global leader in water innovation.

In this regard, we enclose an overview of the Water STRIP, which provides essential details on its objectives and strategic importance. We invite you to review this summary and complete the attached Expression of Interest Form. Your participation in this pioneering initiative will be instrumental in achieving the highest potential benefits, paving the way for groundbreaking developments in water technology.

Please accept my sincere regards and appreciation,

The Deputy Minister of Environment, Water, and Agriculture for Research and
Innovation

Dr. Abdulaziz Malik Almalik

(Consent Form)

Honorable Deputy Minister of Environment, Water, and Agriculture for Research and Innovation,

May God's peace and blessings be upon you.

We would like to inform you that we have reviewed the (Participation Invitation Letter) sent to us under reference number (...) and dated (...), as well as the attached explanatory summary.

We hereby declare our intent to join the Water STRIP, emphasizing that our signing of this form does not entail any financial, legal, or administrative obligations towards any party.

Best regards,

Name:

Position:

Organization:

Signature:

Date:

(Explanatory Summary)

Proposal for the Water STRIP

The Water STRIP aims to unite and mobilize a complementary network of water stakeholders by enhancing coordination and collaboration among members. Located along the Kingdom's western coast, it engages entities from across the country and beyond to drive the national-scale deployment of water technological solutions.

By signing the attached form with the (Invitation to Join) letter, you affirm your interest in joining the Water STRIP.

1. Executive Summary

The Kingdom of Saudi Arabia faces significant challenges in water management, including water scarcity, high desalination costs, inefficient wastewater treatment, and outdated infrastructure.

Addressing these challenges requires the dissemination and adoption of technological solutions nationwide, including innovations related to desalination technologies, water recycling systems, climate-resilient infrastructure, smart water management, and other emerging and mature water technologies.

Deploying these solutions will require collaboration with a wide range of partners inside and outside the Kingdom, leveraging their expertise. This means that the Kingdom has a historic opportunity to establish a comprehensive platform for all stakeholders, including leaders of the water sector, technology experts, and enablers. Achieving this requires the participation of a diverse group of government entities, research and academic institutions, the private sector, non-profit organizations, and international organizations.

Spanning across the Red Sea coastline, the Water STRIP seeks to cultivate a dynamic ecosystem that attracts investment, facilitates research, and accelerates commercialization throughout the Kingdom, focusing on the following goals:

- Strengthen collaboration among research institutions, private sector entities, and government stakeholders to drive water technology advancements
- Develop and implement sustainable water management solutions while informing policymaking and regulations
- Facilitate access to funding, testing facilities, and pilot programs to drive the commercialization of cutting-edge solutions

- Provide a collaborative environment for universities, research institutions, and industry leaders to accelerate knowledge sharing and the development of innovative water technologies

This initiative is under the patronage of the Ministry of Environment, Water, and Agriculture. We invite interested participants to take part in this historic opportunity to unite in facing the water challenges confronting the Kingdom. This opportunity offers many benefits and advantages to members, including shaping the future landscape of the water technology sector in the Kingdom, knowledge and commercial exchange among members, generating new economic opportunities, and contributing to addressing national challenges.

2. Water STRIP Governance & Mandate

The Water STRIP aims to adopt an inclusive approach to participation that includes all stakeholders and allows for the involvement of a wide range of national and international actors with common interests in advancing water technology solutions.

This inclusive approach aims to leverage integrated strategic capabilities and potential cooperation and complementarity among members, including government entities, research and academic institutions, the private sector, and non-profit organizations.

MEWA plays a pivotal role in enabling the Water STRIP by providing essential support, including regulatory frameworks, IP protection, and collaboration opportunities. This involvement ensures that the Water STRIP maintains a balance between agility and responsiveness, facilitating an environment where stakeholders can collectively drive water technology advancements.

The primary mandate of the Water STRIP includes:

- Facilitating cutting-edge research and technology development
- Providing infrastructure for pilot projects and commercialization
- Supporting access to markets, networks, and funding opportunities
- Addressing key water challenges through sustainable and innovative solutions

3. Participation Benefits & Expectations

(i) Participation Types

Water STRIP offers a tiered membership model designed to accommodate different levels of engagement and contribution. Membership is structured across four tiers, enabling organizations to participate through financial support, in-kind resources, or a combination of both, depending on their preference and alignment with Water

STRIP priorities. Optional paid membership tiers will be introduced starting in the 2nd year to support the long-term financial sustainability of Water STRIP.

Water STRIP offers the following four membership tiers:

- a) Member-at-Large
 - Annual Fee: N/A
- b) Ecosystem Member
 - Annual Fee: SAR 5,000 per year
- c) Anchor Member
 - Annual Fee: SAR 100,000 per year

(ii) Participation Benefits

Being a member of the Water STRIP and the level of participation within the initiative entails different benefits across six core benefit categories: data access, infrastructure access, networking and visibility, advisory and project management support, regulatory guidance, and capability building.

1. Water STRIP Benefits Types

Engaging with the Water STRIP provides a unique platform for stakeholders to collaborate, exchange knowledge, and co-develop groundbreaking solutions in the water sector. Key benefit categories include:

- **Data Access:** Members gain access to shared publications, with higher tiers receiving selected or full access to exclusive data, R&D previews, and advanced data insights from government sources, member contributions, and STRIP-led research activities.
- **Infrastructure Access:** Members gain access to shared infrastructure and piloting facilities to support testing, development, and innovation activities.
- **Networking & Visibility:** Members gain enhanced brand exposure through logo placement and acknowledgements across Water STRIP platforms, media, events, and publications, with tiered access to exclusive events, speaking opportunities, and connections to technology developers and investors.
- **Advisory & Project Management:** Members benefit from support in assessing technical and financial feasibility of projects and initiatives within the water sector ecosystem.
- **Regulatory Guidance:** Higher-tier members gain access to regulatory advisory services, sandbox environments, and intellectual property (IP) support to navigate the regulatory landscape.

- **Capability Building:** Top-tier members gain access to specialized workshops designed to enhance organizational capacity and expertise in the water sector.

2. Tier-Specific Benefits

Member-at-Large

- Access to general Water STRIP services and shared infrastructure
- Participation in periodic events and ecosystem publications
- Up to 2 General Admission tickets to exclusive events

Ecosystem Member

All Member-at-Large benefits, in addition to:

- Up to 1 VIP ticket to exclusive events
- Brand recognition and logo inclusion in events and communications
- Access to technology developers
- Support in assessing technology feasibility

Anchor Member

All Ecosystem Member benefits, in addition to:

- Up to 1 VIP and 2 General Admission tickets to exclusive events (total of 3 tickets)
- Promotional video opportunity
- Half-length speaking slot at Water STRIP events
- Access to selected exclusive data and R&D previews
- Access to regulatory advisory services

(iii) Participants' Expectations

Members may contribute through financial support, in-kind resources, or a combination of both, depending on their preference and capacity. Contributions can be made across four core categories:

1. **Financial & Market Enablement:** Direct funding and market development support
2. **Human Capital & Expertise:** Technical talent, advisory capacity, and subject matter expertise
3. **Infrastructure & Operational Support:** Access to facilities, equipment, and testing environments
4. **Knowledge & Ecosystem Access:** Data contributions, research outputs, and network connectivity

(iv) Participants' Expectations



Membership in the Water STRIP does not entail any legally binding obligations or mandatory contributions, whether financial or otherwise. However, we expect our members to attend and participate in events, contribute to knowledge exchange, and adopt a spirit of cooperation with other members.

- **Attendance and Participation:** Members are expected to attend Water STRIP events regularly and contribute to discussions, committees, networking, and other community-building activities.
- **Knowledge and Leadership Exchange:** Members are expected to proactively share non-confidential knowledge and insights with other members through research papers, scientific leadership, presentations, and other materials and insights that serve the common good of the Water STRIP.
- **Work-Oriented Cooperation:** Members are expected to adopt a spirit of cooperation and openness to exploring partnerships and collaboration opportunities with other Water STRIP members in a non-binding manner, ranging from joint research exploration to commercial experimentation opportunities.
- **Water STRIP Membership Status:** Members are expected to be transparent and open about their membership, including granting the Water STRIP the right to report their membership to other parties publicly.

The Water STRIP represents a transformative opportunity to shape the future of Saudi Arabia's water sector. We look forward to the participation of key stakeholders in driving this vision forward.

May God protect and bless you.

